

WORKBOOK

NeuroAdaptiveLeadership®

A Companion Guide to Turn Insight Into Action

ABOUT THIS WORKBOOK

This workbook is your companion to NeuroAdaptive Leadership: Upgrade Your Brain to Lead with Clarity, Confidence, and Speed in the Age of Disruption. It is designed to help you slow down, reflect, and turn the ideas in each chapter into real leadership habits.

HOW TO USE THIS WORKBOOK

- Read a chapter, then complete its page here before moving on to the next one.
- Answer honestly. There is no score for candor, and no one is grading you.
- Keep this workbook somewhere you will see it, and revisit your answers monthly.
- Chapters 9 and 10 will walk you through a full, personalized development plan.

THE A.D.A.P.T. MODEL AT A GLANCE

Attune to Disruption — notice change before it hijacks your thinking.

Decode Thought Patterns — catch the story before it drives the decision.

Align Identity and Intention — make your actions match who you say you are.

Program Adaptivity — turn a new response into your new default.

Transfer Through Culture — make adaptability a habit your team catches too.

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THE CONTEXT FOR NEUROADAPTIVE LEADERSHIP

Chapter 1: Leadership in the Age of Disruption

Disruption is the new normal, and your brain's default response can work for you or against you. Get honest about where uncertainty is testing your leadership right now.

REFLECT

1. Where do you feel the shift from clarity to uncertainty most in your role right now, and how does your brain typically respond when it shows up (freeze, control, avoid, get curious)?

2. Think of a recent moment when you, or someone you lead, defaulted to an old pattern instead of adapting. What triggered it, and what did it cost?

WHAT STOOD OUT

3. What idea in this chapter stood out to you most, or felt most relevant to where you are right now as a leader?

TAKE ACTION

4. What is one place where you are clinging to "the way we've always done it"? What is one small shift you will make this week to practice more mental agility there?

Chapter 2: Upgrading From the Inside Out

Traditional leadership skills still matter, but they are not enough on their own. Real growth starts with upgrading how your brain works, not just what you know.

REFLECT

1. This chapter says leadership today is more neurologically demanding than ever. Where do you feel that demand most: attention, emotional regulation, or decision-making?

2. Neuroplasticity means your brain can change with practice. What is one belief you have held about yourself as a leader ("I've always been this way") that this chapter makes you want to question?

WHAT STOOD OUT

3. What stood out to you most in this chapter, and why does it matter for how you lead?

TAKE ACTION

4. What is one small, repeatable action you will take in the next 30 days to start upgrading a specific part of how you think, feel, or lead?

Chapter 3: The Brain's Blueprint for Adaptivity

This chapter introduces the five-part A.D.A.P.T. model, Attune, Decode, Align, Program, and Transfer, the blueprint you will build throughout the rest of this workbook.

REFLECT

1. Of the five A.D.A.P.T. skills, which one do you sense is your current strength? Which one feels like your growth edge?

2. This chapter explains that reactivity, rigidity, and burnout usually reflect poor brain-system integration, not a lack of intelligence. Does that change how you think about your toughest moments? How?

WHAT STOOD OUT

3. What part of the neuroscience in this chapter stood out most, or felt most useful to you?

TAKE ACTION

4. As you move into Chapters 4 through 8, which A.D.A.P.T. skill do you want to focus on first, and why?

Chapter 4: Attune to Disruption

Attuning means noticing disruption, inside you and around you, before it hijacks your thinking. The more you expect change, the less it can surprise you.

REFLECT

1. This chapter describes scanning for both micro disruptions (an irritating email) and macro disruptions (a reorg). What are your most common disruptions right now, big and small?

2. Which attuning practice, Disruption Scanning, Emotional Tracking, Box Breathing, or the OODA Loop, do you think would help you most, and why?

WHAT STOOD OUT

3. What stood out to you most about how attuning changes the brain, or about Sarah's boardroom story?

TAKE ACTION

4. Pick one attuning practice from this chapter. What exactly will you do, how often, and when will you start this week?

Chapter 5: Decode Thought Patterns

Your thoughts feel like facts, but many are just old, well-worn shortcuts. Decoding means catching the story you are telling yourself before it drives your next decision.

REFLECT

1. Of the five faulty-brain thinking errors (bias, overconfidence, pattern hunger, emotional reasoning, cognitive laziness), which one do you fall into most, and in what situations?

2. Think of a recent moment of friction. Using the 3R Method, what automatic thought were you having, and what is a more accurate or helpful reframe?

WHAT STOOD OUT

3. What stood out to you most in this chapter, or felt most relevant to a pattern you recognize in yourself?

TAKE ACTION

4. Which decoding practice will you commit to using this week, and in what specific moment will you use it?

Chapter 6: Align Identity and Intention

When your identity and your actions match, leadership feels natural instead of forced. This chapter closes the gap between who you say you are and how you actually show up.

REFLECT

1. This chapter distinguishes purpose (your why) from mission (how you live it out). If you had to state your leadership purpose in one sentence right now, what would you say?

2. Think of a moment you acted in a way that did not match who you want to be as a leader. What belief or pressure pulled you out of alignment?

WHAT STOOD OUT

3. What stood out to you most in this chapter: the Mulally story, the neuroscience, or one of the practices?

TAKE ACTION

4. Which alignment practice, Purpose and Mission Crafting, Identity Visualization, "I Am" Statements, or the Gap-Filling Exercise, will you do first, and when will you block time for it?

Chapter 7: Program Adaptivity

Insight alone does not change behavior. Repetition does. Programming adaptivity is how you turn a new response into your new default.

REFLECT

1. Marcus rewired his "freeze" response with a new operating script. What is a default reaction of yours that you would like to reprogram?

2. Habit Loop Mapping asks you to name the cue, routine, and reward behind a habit. Pick one unhelpful habit: what is the cue, what do you actually do, and what is the real reward you get from it?

WHAT STOOD OUT

3. What stood out to you most in this chapter about how your brain builds, and can rebuild, its patterns?

TAKE ACTION

4. Write a short operating script, in the present tense, for one situation where you want to respond differently. When will you start rehearsing it?

Chapter 8: Transfer Through Culture

Your nervous system is contagious. This final skill is about turning your personal adaptability into a shared habit your whole team can catch.

REFLECT

1. This chapter says your team "downloads" your nervous system through mirror neurons. What is your current stress response teaching the people around you?

2. Which transferring practice, NeuroAdaptive Modeling, Feedback Rituals, Story Modeling, or Symbolic Reinforcement, is most missing on your team right now?

WHAT STOOD OUT

3. What stood out to you most in this chapter: Elena's story, the neuroscience, or one of the practices?

TAKE ACTION

4. What is one specific, visible thing you will do in the next two weeks to start transferring neuroadaptive behavior into your team's culture?

Chapter 9: Assessing Your NeuroAdaptability

Before you can strengthen your neuroadaptability, you need to see it clearly. This page is a place to record your results, not to judge them.

STEP 1 • TAKE THE ASSESSMENT

Go to NeuroAdaptiveLeadership.com/NLI and complete the NeuroAdaptive Leader Index (NLI). Answer based on what you actually do under pressure, not who you want to be. It only takes a few minutes, and the online version will calculate your scores for you.

STEP 2 • RECORD YOUR SCORES

Skill	My Score
Overall NeuroAdaptive Leader Index	
Attune to Disruption	
Decode Thought Patterns	
Align Identity and Intention	
Program Adaptivity	
Transfer Through Culture	

Quick reference: Overall score, 220–245 Highly Neuroadaptive · 185–219 Strong · 140–184 Developing · below that, Reactive Adaptation. Each skill (0–49): 42–49 High · 35–41 Moderate · 28–34 Emerging · below 28, Low.

Use the scoring information in the book to understand your skill level for each NeuroAdaptive skill.

STEP 3 • REFLECT ON YOUR RESULTS

1. What surprised you most about your scores, anything higher or lower than you expected?

2. Which score, if it improved, would make the biggest difference in how you lead under pressure right now?

Turn the page to build a simple, focused development plan around what you just learned.

Chapter 10: NeuroAdaptive Development Planning

This is your bridge from insight to change. Using your NLI scores, you will build one simple, focused plan instead of trying to fix everything at once.

STEP 1 · CHOOSE YOUR PRIORITY

Look back at your five A.D.A.P.T. scores on the previous page. Circle your two lowest, then choose the one most likely to sabotage your ability to adapt and lead.

- Attune to Disruption ☐ Decode Thought Patterns ☐ Align Identity and Intention
- Program Adaptivity ☐ Transfer Through Culture

My priority skill: _____

STEP 2 · PICK ONE LEAD BEHAVIOR

Choose one small, specific, repeatable behavior tied to your priority skill. A score is not the target. A behavior is.

Attune → “I run a 2-minute scan before reacting: what changed, what stays true, what's unclear?”

Decode → “I label the story I'm telling myself, then test it with one question.”

Align → “I write my purpose and mission statements and read them weekly.”

Program → “I take one uncomfortable action each day.”

Transfer → “I reinforce the adaptive behavior I see in others within 24 hours.”

My lead behavior: _____

STEP 3 · RUN A 30-DAY SPRINT

My one metric (how I'll track it): _____

Weekly review day: _____

Sprint start date: _____

Sprint end date: _____

STEP 4 · REDUCE FRICTION, ADD SUPPORT

Where will you put a visible reminder? _____

Who will check in with you weekly, and how? _____

STEP 5 · REVIEW AND CHOOSE WHAT'S NEXT

After 30 days, answer these, then retake the NLI and repeat the process for your next area of focus.

What improved? _____

What stayed stubborn? _____

What is my next smallest upgrade? _____

YOUR COMMITMENT

The age of unconscious leadership is ending. The age of conscious evolution has begun.

I, _____, commit to practicing neuroadaptive leadership, starting now.

Date: _____

Signature: _____

KEEP GOING

If NeuroAdaptive Leadership resonated with you, you may also enjoy Dr. Jones's book *Activator: Using Brain Science to Boost Motivation, Deepen Engagement, and Supercharge Performance*.

For keynotes, workshops, or coaching, contact Info@DrJasonJones.com or visit DrJasonJones.com

ABOUT DR. JASON JONES

Dr. Jason Jones is an organizational psychologist, executive coach, and international keynote speaker who helps leaders think more clearly and lead with greater agility under pressure. He is the creator of NeuroAdaptive Leadership® and founder of LeaderPath, where his clients have included Microsoft, IBM, Porsche, AT&T, American Airlines, and the Dallas Cowboys. He is also the author of *Activator* and *28 Days to a Motivated Team*.